

module-06-moon-phases-tithi - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - primary band

Module 6 — Moon Phases and Tithi (Darśana)

Sanskrit: *Candra-pakṣa, Tithi* · **Band:** Primary (3-5) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

The moon's monthly cycle and the Indian lunar calendar.

Darśana note. This workshop condenses Module 6's full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

Opening hook · 5 min

Show a chart of moon phases. “*Did you see the moon last night? Was it round, half, or thin? Today we learn why it changes shape!*”

Core idea · 15 min

The moon changes shape because it goes around Earth.

Two halves of the moon-month: - **Śukla pakṣa** (शुक्ल पक्ष) — bright half — moon grows from tiny to full - **Kṛṣṇa pakṣa** (कृष्ण पक्ष) — dark half — moon shrinks from full to tiny

Each day in each half has a number (tithi 1 to 15). Sing-chant the numbers.

Demonstration · 10 min

Use a lamp (Sun), a tennis ball (moon), and a child's head (Earth) — walk the moon around Earth, watching which side is lit. Children take turns being Moon.

Source moment · 5 min

Tell the moon-grandmother story: the moon visits 30 friends each month (tithis), splitting her time between bright friends (śukla pakṣa) and shadow friends (kṛṣṇa pakṣa).

Hands-on activity · 15 min

Each child draws today's moon and the moon for tomorrow (predicted). Compare with classmates. Send home with a prompt to observe tonight.

Reflection + take-home · 10 min

Each child says one thing they learned about the moon. Cheer.

Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you're skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — The moon's shape — why it changes
- **Day 02** — Pakṣa — bright and dark fortnights
- **Day 03** — 15 tithis — names and computation
- **Day 04** — Building a tithi calendar
- **Day 05** — Lunar months and festivals
- **Day 06** — Pañcāṅga — the five limbs
- **Day 07** — Eclipse geometry
- **Day 08** — Modern lunar science — phases, libration, tides
- **Day 09** — Cross-cultural calendars — Hijri, Chinese, Hebrew
- **Day 10** — Synthesis quiz + moon diary share

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.